

Dear Parent/Guardian:

Children need healthy meals to learn. TC JH/HS offers healthy meals every school day. Breakfast costs \$ 1.75; lunch costs \$ 3.20. Your children may qualify for free meals or for reduced-price meals. Reduced-price is \$ 0.30 for breakfast and \$ 0.40 for lunch. To apply for free or reduced-price meals, use the Household Eligibility Application, which is enclosed. We cannot approve an application that is incomplete, so be sure to fill out all required information.

Return the completed application to: Kerrey Pressler TC JH/HS Office

Your child(ren) may qualify for free or reduced-price meals if your household income falls at or below the limits on this chart.

Income Eligibility Guidelines

Effective from July 1, 2025 to June 30, 2026

Reduced Price Meals					
185% Federal Poverty Guideline					
Household Size	Annual	Monthly	Twice Per Month	Every Two Weeks	Weekly
1	28,953	2,413	1,207	1,114	557
2	39,128	3,261	1,631	1,505	753
3	49,303	4,109	2,055	1,897	949
4	59,478	4,957	2,479	2,288	1,144
5	69,653	5,805	2,903	2,679	1,340
6	79,828	6,653	3,327	3,071	1,536
7	90,003	7,501	3,751	3,462	1,731
8	100,178	8,349	4,175	3,853	1,927
For each additional family member, add	10,175	848	424	392	196

- DO I NEED TO FILL OUT AN APPLICATION FOR EACH CHILD?** No. Complete the application to apply for free or reduced-price meals. *Use one Household Eligibility Application* for all students in your household per district. We cannot approve an application that is not complete, so be sure to fill out all required information. Return the completed application to the school.
- WHO CAN GET FREE MEALS?** All children in households receiving benefits from Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP), households receiving Temporary Assistance for Needy Families (TANF) and/or individual foster children that are under the legal responsibility of a foster care agency or court are eligible for free meals, regardless of your income. Also, your children can get free meals if your household's gross income is within the free limits on the Federal Income Eligibility Guidelines. Children who meet the definition of homeless, runaway, or migrant also qualify for free meals. If you haven't been told your child will get free meals, please contact your school to see if your child(ren) qualifies.
- WHO CAN GET REDUCED-PRICE MEALS?** Your children can get low-cost meals if your household income is within the reduced-price limits on the Federal Income Eligibility Guidelines chart, shown above.
- A MEMBER OF MY HOUSEHOLD RECEIVED SNAP OR TANF BENEFITS. THE SCHOOL SENT A LETTER STATING THAT MY CHILD IS AUTOMATICALLY APPROVED FOR FREE MEALS BASED ON DIRECT CERTIFICATION. DO I NEED TO DO ANYTHING MORE TO ENSURE THAT MY CHILD RECEIVES FREE MEALS?** No. You do not need to do anything more to receive free meals for your child. If you have students not listed on the letter, contact the school immediately. If you do not wish to receive the free meals, you should follow the steps outlined in the letter from the school to notify school personnel immediately.
- HOW DO I KNOW IF MY CHILDREN QUALIFY AS HOMELESS, MIGRANT, OR RUNAWAY?** Do the members of your household lack a permanent address? Are you staying together in a shelter, hotel, or other temporary housing arrangement? Does your family relocate on a seasonal basis? Are any children living with you who have chosen to leave their prior family or household? If you believe children in your household meet these descriptions and haven't been told your children will get free meals, please contact your school.
- MY CHILD'S APPLICATION WAS APPROVED LAST YEAR. DO I NEED TO FILL OUT ANOTHER ONE?** Yes. Your child's application is only good for that school year and for the first few days of this school year. You must send in a new application unless the school has already told you that your child is eligible for the new school year.
- I GET WIC. CAN MY CHILD(REN) GET FREE MEALS?** Children in households participating in WIC may be eligible for free or reduced-price meals. Please fill out the enclosed application and return the completed application to the school.
- WILL THE INFORMATION I GIVE BE CHECKED?** Yes. We may also ask you to send written proof.
- IF I DON'T QUALIFY NOW, MAY I APPLY LATER?** Yes. You may apply at any time during the school year. For example, children with a parent or guardian who becomes unemployed may become eligible for free or reduced-price meals if the household income drops below the income limit.
- WHAT IF I DISAGREE WITH THE SCHOOL'S DECISION ABOUT MY APPLICATION?** You should talk to school officials. You may also ask for a hearing by calling or writing the person listed above.
- MAY I APPLY IF SOMEONE IN MY HOUSEHOLD IS NOT A U.S. CITIZEN?** Yes. You or your child(ren) do not have to be U.S. citizens to qualify for free or reduced-price meals.
- WHO SHOULD I INCLUDE AS MEMBERS OF MY HOUSEHOLD?** You must include all people living in your household, related or not (such as grandparents, other relatives, or friends) who share income and expenses. You must include yourself and all children living with you. If you live with other people who are economically independent (for example, people who you do not support, who do not share income with you or your children, and who pay a pro-rated share of expenses), do not include them.
- WHAT IF MY INCOME IS NOT ALWAYS THE SAME?** List the amount that you normally receive. For example, if you normally make \$1,000 each month, but you missed some work last month and only made \$900, put down that you made \$1,000 per month. If you normally get overtime, include it, but do not include it if you only work overtime occasionally. If you have lost a job or had your hours or wages reduced, use your current income.
- WHAT IF SOME HOUSEHOLD MEMBERS HAVE NO INCOME TO REPORT?** Household members may not receive some types of income we ask you to report on the application or may not receive income at all. If this is the case, write a 0 in the field. However, if any income fields are left empty or blank, those will also be counted as zeroes. Please be careful when leaving income fields blank, as we will assume you meant to do so.
- WE ARE IN THE MILITARY. DO WE REPORT OUR INCOME DIFFERENTLY?** Your basic pay and cash bonuses must be reported as income. If you get any cash value allowances for off-base housing, food, or clothing, it must also be included as income. However, if your housing is part of the Military Housing Privatization Initiative, do not include your housing allowance as income. Any additional combat pay resulting from deployment is also excluded from income.
- MY FAMILY NEEDS MORE HELP. ARE THERE OTHER PROGRAMS WE MIGHT APPLY FOR?** To find out how to apply for SNAP, TANF, or other assistance benefits, contact your local Department of Human Services office or call (800) 843-6154 (voice) or (800) 447-6404 (TTY).

Sincerely,

INSTRUCTIONS FOR APPLYING – COMPLETE ONE APPLICATION PER HOUSEHOLD PER SCHOOL DISTRICT

IF YOUR HOUSEHOLD RECEIVES SNAP OR TANF BENEFITS, FOLLOW THESE INSTRUCTIONS AND RETURN THE COMPLETED FORM TO YOUR SCHOOL:

- Part 1:** List all household members, school and grade level of each student, and a SNAP or TANF case number for any household member including adults receiving such benefits. (Attach another sheet of paper if necessary.)
- Parts 2 & 3:** Skip these parts.
- Part 4:** Sign the form. The last four digits of a Social Security Number are not necessary.
- Parts 5 & 6:** If you choose to, provide contact information and children's ethnic and racial identities. (Information in these two sections is optional).

IF NO ONE IN YOUR HOUSEHOLD GETS SNAP OR TANF BENEFITS AND IF ANY CHILD IN YOUR HOUSEHOLD IS HOMELESS, A MIGRANT OR RUNAWAY OR HEAD START/EVEN START, FOLLOW THESE INSTRUCTIONS AND RETURN THE COMPLETED FORM TO YOUR SCHOOL:

- Part 1:** List all household members; provide the school and grade level of each student in the household. (Attach another sheet of paper if necessary.)
- Part 2:** If any child you are applying for is homeless, migrant, or a runaway, check the appropriate box and call your school.
- Part 3:** Complete only if a child in your household isn't eligible under Part 2. See instructions for All Other Households.
- Part 4:** Adult household member must sign the form. If you completed Part 3 of the application, you must include the last four digits of the adult's Social Security Number (or mark the box if you do not have one).
- Parts 5 & 6:** If you choose to, provide contact information and children's ethnic and racial identities. (Information in these two sections is optional).

IF YOU ARE APPLYING FOR A FOSTER CHILD, FOLLOW THESE INSTRUCTIONS AND RETURN THE COMPLETED FORM TO YOUR SCHOOL:

If all children in the household are foster children that are the legal responsibility of a foster care agency or court:

- Part 1:** List all foster children and the name of each child's school. Check the "Foster Child" box for each foster child.
- Parts 2 & 3:** Skip these parts.
- Part 4:** Sign the form. The last four digits of a Social Security number are not necessary.
- Parts 5 & 6:** If you choose to, provide contact information and children's ethnic and racial identities. (Information in these two sections is optional).

If some (but not all) of the children in the household are foster children that are the legal responsibility of a foster care agency or court:

- Part 1:** List all household members and the name of each child's school. Check the "Foster Child" box for each foster child.
- Part 2:** If any child you are applying for is homeless, migrant, or a runaway, check the appropriate box and call your school.
- Part 3:** Follow these instructions to report total household income from this month or last month.
- **Box 1 – Name:** List all household members with income.
 - **Box 2 – Gross Income and How Often it Was Received:** For each household member, list each type of income received for the month. You must tell us how often the money is received – weekly, every other week, twice a month, or monthly. For earnings, be sure to list the gross income, not the take-home pay. Gross income is the amount earned before taxes and other deductions. You should be able to find it on your pay stub or your boss can tell you. For other income, list the amount each person received for the month from welfare, child support, alimony, pensions, retirement, Social Security, Supplemental Security Income (SSI), Veteran's benefits (VA benefits), and disability benefits. Under All Other Income, list any payment received for Worker's Compensation, unemployment or strike benefits, regular contributions from people who do not live in your household, and any other income. Do not include income from SNAP, FDPIR, WIC, Federal education benefits and foster payments received by the household from the placing agency. For ONLY the self-employed, under Earnings from Work, report income after expenses. This is for your business, farm, or rental property. If you are in the Military Privatized Housing Initiative or receive combat pay, do not include these allowances as income.
- Part 4:** Adult household member must sign the form and list the last four digits of their Social Security Number (or mark the box if you do not have one).
- Parts 5 & 6:** If you choose to, provide contact information and children's ethnic and racial identities. (Information in these two sections is optional).

ALL OTHER HOUSEHOLDS INCLUDING MEDICAID AND WIC HOUSEHOLDS, FOLLOW THESE INSTRUCTIONS:

- Part 1:** List all household members; provide the school and grade level of each student in the household. (Attach another sheet of paper if necessary.)
- Part 2:** If any child you are applying for is homeless, migrant, or a runaway, check the appropriate box and call your school.
- Part 3:** Follow these instructions to report total household income from this month or last month.
- **Box 1 – Name:** List all household members with income.
 - **Box 2 – Gross Income and How Often it Was Received:** For each household member, list each type of income received for the month. You must tell us how often the money is received – weekly, every other week, twice a month, or monthly. For earnings, be sure to list the gross income, not the take-home pay. Gross income is the amount earned before taxes and other deductions. You should be able to find it on your pay stub or your boss can tell you. For other income, list the amount each person received for the month from welfare, child support, alimony, pensions, retirement, Social Security, Supplemental Security Income (SSI), Veteran's benefits (VA benefits), and disability benefits. Under All Other Income, list any payment received for Worker's Compensation, unemployment or strike benefits, regular contributions from people who do not live in your household, and any other income. Do not include income from SNAP, FDPIR, WIC, Federal education benefits and foster payments received by the household from the placing agency. For ONLY the self-employed, under Earnings from Work, report income after expenses. This is for your business, farm, or rental property. If you are in the Military Privatized Housing Initiative or receive combat pay, do not include these allowances as income.
- Part 4:** Adult household member must sign the form and list the last four digits of their Social Security Number (or mark the box if you do not have one).
- Parts 5 & 6:** If you choose to, provide contact information and children's ethnic and racial identities. (Information in these two sections is optional).

Privacy Act Statement: This explains how we will use the information you give us. The Richard B. Russell National School Lunch Act requires the information on this application. You do not have to give the information, but if you do not, we cannot approve your child for free or reduced-price meals. You must include the last four digits of the social security number of the adult household member who signs the application. The last four digits of the social security number is not required when you apply on behalf of a foster child or you list a Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP), Temporary Assistance for Needy Families (TANF) Program, or Food Distribution Program on Indian Reservations (FDPIR) case number or other FDPIR identifier for your child or when you indicate that the adult household member signing the application does not have a social security number. We will use your information to determine if your child is eligible for free or reduced-price meals and for administration and enforcement of the lunch and breakfast programs. We may share your eligibility information with education, health, and nutrition programs to help them deliver program benefits to your household. Inspectors and law enforcement may also use your information to make sure that program rules are met.

In accordance with the federal civil rights law and U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) civil rights regulations and policies, this institution is prohibited from discriminating on the basis of race, color, national origin, sex (including gender identity and sexual orientation), disability, age, or reprisal or retaliation for prior civil rights activity. Program information may be made available in languages other than English. Persons with disabilities who require alternative means of communication to obtain program information (e.g., Braille, large print, audiotape, American Sign Language), should contact the responsible state or local agency that administers the program or USDA's TARGET Center at (202) 720-2600 (voice and TTY) or contact USDA through the Federal Relay Service at (800) 877-8339. To file a program discrimination complaint, a Complainant should complete a Form AD-3027, USDA Program Discrimination Complaint Form which can be obtained online at <https://www.usda.gov/sites/default/files/documents/USDA-OASCR%20P-Complaint-Form-0508-0002-508-11-28-17Fax2Mail.pdf>, from any USDA office, by calling (866) 632-9992, or by writing a letter addressed to USDA. The letter must contain the complainant's name, address, telephone number, and a written description of the alleged discriminatory action in sufficient detail to inform the Assistant Secretary for Civil Rights (ASCR) about the nature and date of an alleged civil rights violation. The completed AD-3027 form or letter must be submitted to USDA by: 1) mail: U.S. Department of Agriculture, Office of the Assistant Secretary for Civil Rights, 1400 Independence Avenue, SW, Washington D.C. 20250-9410; or 2) fax: (833) 256-1665 or (202) 690-7442; or 3) email: program.intake@usda.gov.

APPLICATION FOR FREE MILK/MEAL, REDUCED-PRICE MEALS, AND SUMMER EBT

Complete one application per household, per school district. Instructions on the back of this form.

SCHOOL USE ONLY☐ Check if Error Prone Application**1. All Household Members (Attach another sheet of paper if necessary)**

NAMES OF ALL HOUSEHOLD MEMBERS (Include school name and grade if household member is a student.)			SNAP OR TANF CASE NUMBER ONLY	Check if Foster Child*
First, Middle Initial, Last	School Name	Grade	Skip to part 4 if you list a SNAP or TANF case number. At least one SNAP/TANF must be provided below. If you receive Medicaid and were not directly certified for free meals, you MUST apply based on household size and income.	
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐
				☐

* A foster child is the legal responsibility of a welfare agency or court.

2. Homeless, Migrant, Runaway, or Head Start (Categorically Eligible)

☐ Homeless	☐ Migrant	☐ Runaway	☐ Head Start	Signature of your school Homeless Liaison, Migrant Coordinator, or Head Start Director	Date
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3. Total Household Gross Income (before deductions). You must tell us how much and how often.

A. NAMES (LIST ALL HOUSEHOLD MEMBERS WITH INCOME)	GROSS INCOME AND HOW OFTEN IT WAS RECEIVED (Example: \$100/month; \$100/twice a month; \$100/every other week; \$100/week)							
	B. Earnings from Work (Before Deductions)		C. Welfare, Child Support, Alimony		D. Pensions, Retirement, Social Security		E. All Other Income (Worker's Comp., SSI, Unemployment, etc.)	
	Amount	How often?	Amount	How often?	Amount	How often?	Amount	How often?
i. _____	\$ _____	_____	\$ _____	_____	\$ _____	_____	\$ _____	_____
ii. _____	\$ _____	_____	\$ _____	_____	\$ _____	_____	\$ _____	_____
iii. _____	\$ _____	_____	\$ _____	_____	\$ _____	_____	\$ _____	_____
iv. _____	\$ _____	_____	\$ _____	_____	\$ _____	_____	\$ _____	_____
v. _____	\$ _____	_____	\$ _____	_____	\$ _____	_____	\$ _____	_____

4. Signature and Social Security Number (Adult Must Sign)

An adult household member must sign the application. If Part 3 is completed, the adult signing the form must also list the last four digits of his or her social security number or mark the box if they do not have a social security number.

 X X X X - X X - OR ☐ I do not have a social security number.
Social Security Number

I certify (promise) all information on this application is true and all income is reported. I understand the school will get Federal funds based on the information I give. I understand school officials may verify (check) the information. I understand if I purposely give false information, my children may lose meal benefits and I may be prosecuted.

Date	Printed Name of Adult Household Member	Signature of Adult Household Member
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5. Contact Information (optional)

Work Telephone Number (Include Area Code)	Home Telephone Number (Include Area Code)	Home Address (Number, Street, City, State, ZIP Code)
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6. Children's Ethnic and Racial Identities (optional)

Mark one ethnic identity:

- ☐ Hispanic/Latino
☐ Not Hispanic/Latino

Mark one or more racial identities:

- ☐ Asian ☐ Black or African American
☐ White ☐ American Indian or Alaska Native
☐ Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander

- THIS SECTION IS FOR SCHOOL USE ONLY -**INITIAL DETERMINATION**

TOTAL INCOME	Per:	☐ Week	☐ Every 2 Weeks	☐ Twice a Month	☐ Month	☐ Year	NUMBER IN HOUSEHOLD:	CHANGE IN STATUS:	DATE
\$ _____									

LEAS must annualize income ONLY when multiple incomes at varying frequencies are reported.

Annual Income Conversion:	Weekly \$ _____ x 52 = \$ _____	Every 2 Weeks \$ _____ x 26 = \$ _____	Twice a Month \$ _____ x 24 = \$ _____	Once a month \$ _____ x 12 = \$ _____
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☐ Free based on:

- ☐ Homeless ☐ SNAP or TANF
☐ Migrant ☐ Foster Child
☐ Runaway ☐ Household's Income
☐ Head Start

☐ Reduced based on:

- ☐ Household's Income

☐ Denied - Reason

- ☐ Income too high
☐ Incomplete Application
☐ Non-Qualifying SNAP/TANF

Signature of Determining Official

Date Withdrawn: _____

Date: _____